Cornell University

ROPER CENTER

31099261
USYANK1992-65217

Country: United States

Title: Yankelovich/Time Magazine/CNN Poll: Rodney King Verdict and the Los Angeles Riots

Survey Organizations: Yankelovich Clancy Shulman

Sponsors: Time Magazine; Cable News Network (CNN)

Field Dates: April 30, 1992

Sample: National adult including an oversample of 102 Black adults

Sample Size: 1102

Interview Modes: Telephone Interview

Weight Location: Columns 74-77 (x.xxx) -- Varname: WEIGHT

Usage Notes: Columns locations are found to the right of the question in this format (CC), where CC = Column(s).

Please note that data provided by the Roper Center for Public Opinion Research may not be re-disseminated without written permission. The results of any analyses conducted on the data may, however, be published with appropriate acknowledgments and source citation.

Yankelovich Clancy Shulman
8 Wright Street
Westport, CT 06880

Study #65217
April 30, 1992

1- 2- 3- 4-

TELEPHONE INTERVIEW
TIME MAGAZINE

FINAL *FINAL*

==========

IDENTIFICATION - (COMPLETE AT END OF INTERVIEW)

==========

CF#: | | | | | | | |
5- 6- 7- 8- 9- 10- 11-

==========

Name: _____

City: _____ State: _____ Zip: _____

Area Code: | | | 12- 13- 14- Telephone Number: | | | 15- 16- 17- - | | | | 18- 19- 20- 21-

Month/Date

| | | | 22- 23-

Interviewer: _____

Time Started: _____ Time Ended: _____

Validated: _____ Elapsed Time: _____ Minutes

| | 78- 79-

==========

CARD 1, COL. 24

1 = REGULAR GENERAL POPULATION SAMPLE

2 = BLACK OVERSAMPLE

c Yankelovich, Skelly and White/Clancy, Shulman 1992

1. How much have you seen or heard about last night's verdict in the trial involving four Los Angeles police officers who were videotaped beating a black man named Rodney King, and the outbreaks of violence in Los Angeles after the verdict was announced -- a great deal, some, not much, or none at all?

A great deal..... -1
Some..... -2
Not much..... -3 26
None at all..... -4
Not sure (VOL.)..... -5

2. Have you seen any part of the videotape which shows the police officers beating Rodney King, or haven't you seen that videotape?

Have seen it..... -1
Have not..... -2 27
Not sure (VOL.)..... -3

(IF HAVE SEEN VIDEOTAPE:)

3. Some jurors say they found the police officers not guilty because circumstances not seen on the videotape justified the use of that amount of force against Rodney King. Do you think there are any circumstances in which police officers should be allowed to use the amount of force the videotape shows, or would you consider that amount of force to be excessive under any circumstances?

Justified in some circumstances.. -1
Excessive under any
circumstances..... -2 28
Not sure (VOL.)..... -3

4. If you had been on the jury, do you think you would have voted to find the police officers guilty or not guilty?

Guilty..... -1
Not guilty..... -2 29
Guilty on some charges (VOL.).... -3
Not sure (VOL.)..... -4

5. Before the verdict was announced, did you think the police officers would be found guilty or not guilty?

Guilty..... -1
Not guilty..... -2 30
Guilty on some charges (VOL.).... -3
Not sure (VOL.)..... -4

5a. From what you have read or seen, do you think the police clubbing was racially motivated, or not?

Racially motivated..... -1
Not racially motivated..... -2 64
Not sure (VOL.)..... -3

6. In general, do you think that the country's criminal justice system treats whites and blacks equally, or does it favor whites over blacks?

Treats whites and blacks equally. -1
Favors whites over blacks..... -2
Favors blacks over
whites (VOL.)..... -3 32
Depends (VOL.)..... -4
Not sure (VOL.)..... -5

(IF FAVORS WHITES OVER BLACKS)

7. Did you think that the criminal justice system favors whites over blacks before you heard about the verdict in the Rodney King case, or not?

Before King verdict..... -1 33
Not before King verdict..... -2
Not sure (VOL.)..... -3

8. In general, do you think the police are allowed to use too much force, or are they not allowed to use enough force, or is the amount of force they are allowed to use about right?

Too much..... -1
Too little..... -2
About right..... -3 34
Not sure (VOL.)..... -4

9. Who do you sympathize with more -- the police officers or Rodney King?

Police..... -1
King..... -2
Both equally (VOL.)..... -3 35
Neither (VOL.)..... -4
Not sure (VOL.)..... -5

10. In general, how many police officers in the area where you live do you feel are prejudiced against blacks -- most of them, some of them, only a few of them, or almost none of them?

Most of them..... -1
Some of them..... -2
Only a few of them..... -3 36
Almost none of them..... -4
All of them (VOL.)..... -5
None of them (VOL.)..... -6
Not sure (VOL.)..... -7

11. In an everyday encounter with the police, do you ever feel that you are at risk of being treated unfairly?

Yes..... -1
No..... -2 31
Not sure (VOL.)..... -3

12. Do you think the verdict in the Rodney King case would have been different or would have remained the same if:

	Different	Remained the Same	Not Sure (VOL.)	
a. There had been any blacks on the jury.....	-1	-2	-3	37
b. The police and the man they had beaten had all been white.....	-1	-2	-3	38
c. The police and the man they had beaten had all been black.....	-1	-2	-3	39
d. The police had been black and the man they had beaten had been white.....	-1	-2	-3	40

13. Should the U.S. Department of Justice file charges of civil rights violations against the four Los Angeles police officers, or not?

Should file charges..... -1 52
Should not..... -2
Not sure (VOL.)..... -3

14. Which of the following describes the reason for the jury's ruling of not guilty -- racism, loyalty to the police, inadequate evidence to convict, a good defense, or poor prosecution?

Racism..... -1
Loyalty to police..... -2
Inadequate defense to convict... -3 53
Good defense..... -4
Poor prosecution..... -5
Not sure (VOL.)..... -6

Now I would like to ask you a few questions about the outbreak of violence in Los Angeles last night after the verdict in the Rodney King case was announced.

15. How much of that violence do you feel was justified by the anger that blacks in Los Angeles felt over the verdict in the trial? Was the violence completely justified, somewhat justified, somewhat unjustified, or completely unjustified?

Completely justified	-1
Somewhat justified	-2
Somewhat unjustified	-3
Completely unjustified	-4
Not sure (VOL.)	-5

4/2

16. Is the situation in Los Angeles mostly a genuine reaction to the verdict in the Rodney King case, or mostly people taking advantage of the situation to justify violence and looting?

Genuine reaction	-1
Taking advantage	-2
Both (VOL.)	-3
Neither (VOL.)	-4
Not sure (VOL.)	-5

54

17. Which makes you angrier -- the verdict or the violence that followed, or do neither make you angry?

Verdict	-1
Violence	-2
Neither	-3
Both equally (VOL.)	-4
Not sure (VOL.)	-5

55

18. Do you think President Bush should speak out more strongly about the verdict in the Rodney King case and the violence that followed, or was his reaction about right?

More strongly	-1
About right	-2
Too strongly (VOL.)	-3
Not sure (VOL.)	-4

56

19. If any people involved in the violence are identified on the basis of videotapes made last night in Los Angeles, do you think they will be brought to trial and convicted, be brought to trial but not convicted, or never brought to trial?

Trial and convicted	-1
Trial, not convicted	-2
Never brought to trial	-3
Not sure (VOL.)	-4

57

20. What is your race? Are you White, Black, Asian or something else?

White	-1
Black	-2
Asian	-3
Hispanic (VOLUNTEERED)	-4
Other (VOLUNTEERED)	-5
No answer	-6

44

(ASK OF WHITES)

21. In general, which of these descriptions do you think apply to blacks more than whites and which do not:

	Applies	Does Not Apply	Not Sure (VOL.)	
a. Are always whining about racism	-1	-2	-3	45
b. Are more likely to commit violent crimes	-1	-2	-3	46
c. Have no self-discipline	-1	-2	-3	47

(ASK OF BLACKS)

22. Do you think that most white Americans hold the following perceptions of black Americans or not?

	Yes	No	Not Sure (VOL.)	
a. Are always whining about racism	-1	-2	-3	48
b. Are more likely to commit violent crimes	-1	-2	-3	49
c. Have no self-discipline	-1	-2	-3	50

23. Overall, do you think that prejudice and discrimination against blacks have become more prevalent in recent years, less prevalent, or has it remained the same?

More prevalent	-1
Less prevalent	-2
Remained the same	-3
Not sure (VOL.)	-4

51

CLASSIFICATION DATA

Now I have a few questions for classification purposes.

A. What is your age? (READ LIST)

18 - 24 years	-1
25 - 29 years	-2
30 - 34 years	-3
35 - 39 years	-4
40 - 49 years	-5
50 - 64 years	-6
65 years and over	-7
Refused	-8

58

B. What is the last grade of school you completed? (READ LIST)

8th grade or less	-1
Some high school	-2
High school graduate	-3
Some college	-4
College graduate	-5
Postgraduate study	-6
Refused	-7

59

C. What is your marital status?

Married	-1
Single/never married	-2
Divorced/separated	-3
Widowed	-4
Refused	-5

60

D. How many people, including yourself, live in this household?

One	-1
Two	-2
Three	-3
Four	-4
Five or more	-5
Refused/Not sure	-6

61

E. Is your total family income before taxes: (READ LIST)

Less than $20,000	-1
$20,000 - $35,000	-2
$35,000 - $50,000	-3
$50,000 or more	-4
Refused	-5

62

F. Are you of Hispanic origin or descent?

Yes	-1
No	-2
Refused	-3

63

H.

RECORD, DO NOT ASK. 125

Sex:	Male	-1
	Female	-2

CARD ONE

CLUSTER FRAME DEFINITIONS

1st Digit - Census Division — Col. 5

1 - New England
2 - Middle Atlantic
3 - East North Central
4 - West North Central
5 - South Central
6 - East South Central
7 - West South Central
8 - Moutain
9 - Pacific

2nd Digit - Met Area Size — Col. 6

1 - Metropolitan Area
2 - Non-Metropolitan Area

3rd Digit - Neilson Code — Col. 7

1 - A
2 - B
3 - C
4 - D

4th and 5th Digits - State Codes — Col. 8-9

See Attached

6th Digit - Watts House — Col. 10

1 - Delta
2 - Intersearch
3 - Mkt. Decisions Inc.

7th Digit - Night of Interview — Col. 11

STATE CODES

State	AB	Code
Alabama	AL	01
Alaska	AK	02
Arizona	AZ	04
Arkansas	AR	05
California	CA	06
Colorado	CO	08
Connecticut	CT	09
Deleware	DE	10
Washington D.C.	DC	11
Florida	FL	12
Georgia	GA	13
Hawaii	HI	15
Idaho	ID	16
Illinois	IL	17
Indiana	IN	18
Iowa	IA	19
Kansas	KS	20
Kentucky	KY	21
Louisiana	LA	22
Maine	ME	23
Maryland	MD	24
Massachusettes	MA	25
Michigan	MI	26
Minnesota	MN	27
Mississippi	MS	28
Missouri	MO	29
Montana	MT	30
Nebraska	NE	31
Nevada	NV	32
New Hampshire	NH	33
New Jersey	NJ	34
New Mexico	NM	35
New York	NY	36
North Carolina	NC	37
North Dakota	ND	38
Ohio	OH	39
Oklahoma	OK	40
Oregon	OR	41
Pennsylvania	PA	42
Rhode Island	RI	44
South Carolina	SC	45
South Dakota	SD	46
Tennessee	TN	47
Texas	TX	48
Utah	UT	49
Vermont	VT	50
Virginia	VA	51
Washington	WA	53
West Virginia	WV	54
Wisconsin	WI	55
Wyoming	WY	56
All Foreign Countries		99

Column Frequencies for USYANK1998-68217 TYPE=ONEASC FORM 1 CARD 1 (COL=0)
Source: The Roper Center, 07/28/2011 Records = 1102

COL	&	-	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	BLANK	OTHER	NONBLNK	COL
1	0	0	796	0	0	306	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	1
2	0	0	170	187	170	133	95	97	94	82	74	0	0	0	1102	2
3	0	0	112	110	119	107	111	106	113	108	101	105	0	0	1102	3
4	0	0	112	108	115	111	112	111	113	108	101	111	0	0	1102	4
5	0	0	0	87	174	190	77	214	73	112	50	155	0	0	1102	5
6	0	0	0	854	248	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	6
7	0	0	0	445	328	148	181	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	7
8	0	0	189	196	196	229	199	93	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	8
9	0	0	33	94	141	68	83	76	259	119	122	107	0	0	1102	9
10	0	0	0	796	306	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	10
11	0	0	0	1102	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	11
12	0	0	0	0	181	138	134	138	126	176	111	99	0	0	1102	12
13	0	0	509	593	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	13
14	0	0	29	78	119	167	170	121	107	100	123	88	0	0	1102	14
15	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	0	0	15
16	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	0	0	16
17	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	0	0	17
18	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	0	0	18
19	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	0	0	19
20	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	0	0	20
21	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	0	0	21
22	0	0	0	0	0	1102	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	22
23	0	0	1102	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	23
24	0	0	0	1000	102	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	24
25	0	0	0	546	556	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	25
26	0	0	0	624	337	106	32	3	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	26
27	0	0	0	1052	49	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	27
28	0	0	0	146	796	110	0	0	0	0	0	0	50	0	1052	28
29	0	0	0	718	41	23	320	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	29
30	0	0	0	856	101	15	130	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	30
31	0	0	0	313	723	66	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	31
32	0	0	0	254	575	18	85	170	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	32
33	0	0	0	494	55	26	0	0	0	0	0	0	527	0	575	33
34	0	0	0	476	48	378	200	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	34
35	0	0	0	96	720	65	122	99	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	35
36	0	0	0	99	165	224	277	5	67	265	0	0	0	0	1102	36
37	0	0	0	749	173	180	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	37
38	0	0	0	573	345	184	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	38
39	0	0	0	502	399	201	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	39
40	0	0	0	648	290	164	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	40
41	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	0	0	41
42	0	0	0	63	158	160	662	59	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	42
43	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	0	0	43
44	0	0	0	798	200	18	33	34	19	0	0	0	0	0	1102	44
45	0	0	0	364	322	122	0	0	0	0	0	0	304	0	798	45
46	0	0	0	274	387	137	0	0	0	0	0	0	304	0	798	46
47	0	0	0	125	516	157	0	0	0	0	0	0	304	0	798	47
48	0	0	0	148	36	16	0	0	0	0	0	0	902	0	200	48
49	0	0	0	161	25	14	0	0	0	0	0	0	902	0	200	49
50	0	0	0	136	44	20	0	0	0	0	0	0	902	0	200	50
51	0	0	0	387	256	399	60	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	51
52	0	0	0	800	166	136	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	52
53	0	0	0	194	216	172	108	226	186	0	0	0	0	0	1102	53
54	0	0	0	290	595	140	10	67	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	54
55	0	0	0	335	317	81	343	26	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	55
56	0	0	0	507	281	15	299	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	56
57	0	0	0	403	84	455	160	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	57
58	0	0	0	124	136	149	149	200	180	147	17	0	0	0	1102	58
59	0	0	0	29	92	302	283	239	141	16	0	0	0	0	1102	59
60	0	0	0	622	295	85	82	18	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	60
61	0	0	0	166	360	190	227	132	27	0	0	0	0	0	1102	61
62	0	0	0	228	285	199	232	158	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	62
63	0	0	0	74	994	34	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	63
64	0	0	0	486	293	323	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	64
65	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	0	0	65
66	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	0	0	66
67	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	0	0	67
68	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	0	0	68
69	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	0	0	69
70	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	0	0	70
71	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	0	0	71
72	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	0	0	72
73	0	0	1102	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	73
74	0	0	594	451	52	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	74
75	0	0	109	124	119	79	92	118	97	190	101	63	0	0	1102	75
76	0	0	116	84	135	118	104	118	91	137	117	83	0	0	1102	76
77	0	0	104	87	124	95	102	136	124	119	117	95	0	0	1102	77
78	0	0	552	525	21	3	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	1101	78
79	0	0	170	128	94	58	42	31	59	134	200	185	1	0	1101	79

Column Frequencies for USYANK1992-65217 TYPE=ONEASC FORM 1 CARD 1 COL=0
Source: The Roper Center, 07/28/2011 Records = 1102

COL	&	-	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	BLANK	OTHER	NONBLNK	COL
80	0	0	0	1102	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1102	80